Assumptions and decisions

Malena Kuipers · Trolley Account Manager assessment, Test A · Founders Summit, Los Angeles

Assumptions

What I assumed	Why	Type
The founder is called Anna	Placeholder name for reference; the pack doesn't name her.	ASSUMED
Event is Thu–Fri, Dec 3–4, 2026	"Five weeks from today." Weekdays suit a founder summit. First thing I confirm on the call.	ASSUMED
My first day on the account is Mon, Nov 2	The submission is due Sun, Nov 1.	ASSUMED
The 260 capacity may count everyone in the room	Fire codes usually count staff, crew, speakers and sponsor teams. With them we may be at ~283. Must be confirmed in writing by the venue.	TO CONFIRM
The keynote the founder wants to move is on day one	The pack doesn't say. It pairs with the night-one VIP dinner (keynote 6–7pm, dinner 7:45pm).	ASSUMED
Catering is about $76 per guest per day	$38,000 ÷ 250 guests ÷ 2 days. Assumes linear pricing; real change terms are in the contract.	ESTIMATE
VIP dinner for 40 costs about $8,500	40 × ~$175 for LA private dining incl. tax and service, plus ~$1,500 room and decor. Replaced by real quotes this week.	ESTIMATE
Moving the keynote to 6pm costs about $2,000	Extra venue hours, AV crew and catering staff.	ESTIMATE
Sponsor 4's fee could cover the dinner	Sponsor fees aren't in the pack. I check the number before pitching.	TO CONFIRM
The client team owns the guest list and registration	Usual split: client owns who comes, Trolley owns production.	ASSUMED
Sponsor teams ~12 people, crew ~10, client team ~5	Used only for the headcount check.	ESTIMATE

Decisions

- **Hold the guest list at 250 with a waitlist.** 300 doesn't fit a 260-person room, and we may already be at the limit. Safety and the catering lock come first.
- **Recommend funding the VIP dinner through the fourth sponsor (Option B).** It turns a verbal yes into a contract and protects a budget with only 2% contingency.
- **Ask the founder for a decision by Thursday, Nov 5.** She asked for confirmation by Friday. Thursday gives me a day to confirm with vendors.
- **Lock catering headcount internally on Fri, Nov 13.** The vendor deadline (14 days) falls on Sunday, Nov 15.
- **Contingency is not spent without founder OK.** At $3,000 it's my only buffer.
- **Photo and video at $5,000 don't need founder approval.** The rule is "above $5,000". Anything over that goes to her.
- **Plan all vendor confirmations by Nov 24.** Thanksgiving (Nov 26–27) takes most US vendors offline.
- **Nothing is announced until it's signed**, especially the headliner.

AI use

I used Claude to structure the tracker, check word limits, pressure-test the budget math and run the Daily Pulse workflow on the scenario pack. The judgment calls and the final wording are mine.